Constitution and Bylaws of the Northstar Society

Document ID: NS-BYL-2026-001
Version: 1.2
Adopted: 15 March 2026
Effective Date: 1 April 2026
Status: In Force

Preamble

The Northstar Society (hereinafter referred to as “the Society”) is a fictional, non-profit social and cultural club established to promote intellectual curiosity, community engagement, outdoor recreation, and lifelong learning among its members.

These bylaws govern the organization, membership, administration, finances, and activities of the Society. All members, officers, and committees shall act in accordance with these provisions.

Article I — Name, Purpose, and Registered Office

Section 1.1 — Name

The organization shall be known as the **Northstar Society**.

Section 1.2 — Purpose

The Society exists to:

1. Organize educational, cultural, recreational, and social events.
2. Encourage collaboration and the exchange of knowledge among members.
3. Support local community initiatives through voluntary service.
4. Maintain a welcoming environment free from harassment and discrimination.
5. Promote responsible use of shared resources.

The Society shall not distribute profits to its members. Any surplus shall be reinvested in activities consistent with its purpose.

Section 1.3 — Registered Office

The registered office shall be located in the fictional city of Lindenfeld. The Executive Committee may change the office address by a simple majority vote, provided that members are notified within fourteen (14) calendar days.

Article II — Membership

Section 2.1 — Eligibility

Membership is open to individuals aged eighteen (18) or older who support the Society's purpose and agree to comply with these bylaws and the Society's code of conduct.

No applicant shall be denied membership solely on the basis of nationality, ethnicity, gender, disability, religion, or political belief.

Section 2.2 — Membership Categories

The Society shall maintain four membership categories:

- **Regular Members:** Individuals with full voting rights who pay the annual membership fee.
- **Student Members:** Individuals enrolled in a recognized educational institution who pay the reduced student fee. Student Members have the same voting rights as Regular Members.
- **Honorary Members:** Individuals recognized for exceptional contributions to the Society. Honorary Members are exempt from membership fees but may not vote unless they also hold another eligible membership category.
- **Supporting Members:** Individuals who contribute financially or materially to the Society but do not participate in its governance. Supporting Members have no voting rights.

A person may not simultaneously hold more than one membership category.

Section 2.3 — Application Procedure

Applicants shall submit a written or electronic application to the Secretary. The Executive Committee shall decide on complete applications within twenty-one (21) calendar days.

An application may be rejected by a two-thirds majority of the Executive Committee if the applicant's participation would present a demonstrable risk to the Society or its members. The applicant shall receive written notice of the decision and may appeal under Section 2.7.

Section 2.4 — Membership Fees

The annual membership fees shall be:

Membership category	Annual fee
Regular Member	€60

Student Member	€30
Honorary Member	€0
Supporting Member	€20 minimum

Fees are due on 1 January each year. Members joining after 1 July shall pay fifty percent (50%) of the applicable annual fee for that calendar year.

The General Assembly may change the fees by a simple majority vote, provided that the proposed change appears on the meeting agenda.

Section 2.5 — Rights and Obligations

Eligible voting members may attend General Assemblies, vote on motions, stand for elected office, and submit proposals in accordance with these bylaws.

All members shall:

1. Treat other members respectfully.
2. Pay applicable fees by the prescribed deadlines.
3. Use Society property responsibly.
4. Protect confidential information obtained through Society activities.
5. Comply with properly adopted decisions and policies.

Section 2.6 — Resignation and Termination

A member may resign at any time by submitting written notice to the Secretary. Resignation takes effect upon receipt unless a later date is specified.

Membership may also terminate through death, expulsion under Section 2.8, or non-payment under Section 2.9.

Membership fees already paid are non-refundable, except where the Executive Committee determines that an administrative error or exceptional circumstance justifies a refund.

Section 2.7 — Appeals

An applicant whose membership application has been rejected may appeal in writing within fourteen (14) calendar days of receiving the decision.

The General Assembly shall decide the appeal at its next scheduled meeting. The appellant must be given an opportunity to submit a written statement. The General Assembly's decision shall be final within the Society.

Section 2.8 — Disciplinary Action and Expulsion

A member may face disciplinary action for serious misconduct, repeated violations of these bylaws, harassment, misuse of Society funds, or intentional damage to Society property.

The Executive Committee may issue a warning, suspend specific membership privileges for up to sixty (60) days, or recommend expulsion.

Expulsion requires a two-thirds majority vote of the Executive Committee. Before the vote, the affected member shall receive written notice of the allegations at least seven (7) calendar days in advance and an opportunity to respond.

An expelled member may appeal to the General Assembly within fourteen (14) calendar days. The appeal does not automatically restore membership privileges pending the decision.

Section 2.9 — Non-Payment of Fees

A member whose annual fee remains unpaid thirty (30) calendar days after the due date shall receive a written reminder.

If payment remains outstanding sixty (60) calendar days after the due date, voting rights and access to member-only activities may be suspended.

If payment remains outstanding for ninety (90) calendar days after the due date, the Executive Committee may terminate membership by a simple majority vote. This provision does not apply to Honorary Members.

A member may request a payment extension of up to sixty (60) additional days from the Treasurer. The Treasurer may approve one extension per calendar year based on financial hardship.

Article III — Governance

Section 3.1 — Governing Bodies

The Society shall be governed by:

1. The General Assembly.
2. The Executive Committee.
3. Standing and temporary committees established under Article VI.

The General Assembly is the highest decision-making body of the Society. All other bodies are subordinate to its authority and these bylaws.

Section 3.2 — General Assembly

The General Assembly shall consist of all members. Only Regular Members and Student Members in good standing may vote.

The Ordinary General Assembly shall take place at least once per calendar year, preferably during the first quarter.

The General Assembly shall:

- Elect and remove Executive Committee officers.
- Approve the annual budget and financial report.
- Determine membership fees.
- Amend these bylaws.
- Decide appeals referred to it under these bylaws.
- Decide on dissolution of the Society.

Section 3.3 — Extraordinary General Assembly

An Extraordinary General Assembly may be convened by the Chairperson, by a majority of the Executive Committee, or upon a written request signed by at least twenty-five percent (25%) of all eligible voting members.

The meeting shall take place within thirty (30) calendar days of a valid request. If the Executive Committee fails to convene the meeting within that period, the requesting members may organize it themselves.

Only matters stated in the meeting notice may be decided at an Extraordinary General Assembly.

Section 3.4 — Notice and Agenda

Members shall receive notice of a General Assembly at least fourteen (14) calendar days before the meeting.

The notice shall specify the date, time, location or electronic meeting link, and proposed agenda.

Members may submit agenda proposals up to seven (7) calendar days before the meeting. Proposals submitted after this deadline may be considered only with the consent of two-thirds of the members present and eligible to vote.

Section 3.5 — Quorum

A General Assembly shall have a quorum when at least thirty percent (30%) of all eligible voting members are present in person or participating through an approved electronic meeting platform.

If a quorum is not reached, the meeting shall be adjourned and reconvened within twenty-one (21) calendar days. At the reconvened meeting, the quorum requirement shall be fifteen percent (15%) of eligible voting members.

The reduced quorum shall not apply to motions concerning amendments to these bylaws, removal of elected officers, or dissolution of the Society. Such matters require the quorum specified in their respective articles.

Section 3.6 — Voting

Unless otherwise specified in these bylaws, decisions shall be made by a simple majority of valid votes cast.

Abstentions shall not count as votes cast. A tie shall result in the motion being rejected.

Voting shall normally take place by a show of hands or electronic ballot. A secret ballot shall be required for officer elections when at least one eligible voting member requests it.

Proxy voting is prohibited. Electronic participation and voting are permitted if the identity and eligibility of each voter can be reasonably verified.

Article IV — Executive Committee

Section 4.1 — Composition

The Executive Committee shall consist of five (5) elected officers:

1. Chairperson.
2. Vice-Chairperson.
3. Secretary.
4. Treasurer.
5. Events Coordinator.

No person may hold more than one of these offices simultaneously.

Section 4.2 — Election and Term

Officers shall be elected by the General Assembly for a term of two (2) years and may be re-elected for one additional consecutive term in the same office.

After serving two consecutive terms in the same office, an individual must leave that office for at least one full term before becoming eligible to hold it again.

An officer's term begins immediately following the conclusion of the meeting at which the election takes place, unless the General Assembly specifies a later commencement date.

Section 4.3 — Duties of the Chairperson

The Chairperson shall:

- Represent the Society in official matters.
- Preside over General Assembly and Executive Committee meetings.
- Ensure that decisions are implemented.
- Coordinate the work of the Executive Committee.

- Authorize expenditures in accordance with Article V.

The Chairperson may not unilaterally amend the bylaws, dismiss another elected officer, or authorize expenditure exceeding the limits in Article V.

Section 4.4 — Duties of the Vice-Chairperson

The Vice-Chairperson shall assist the Chairperson and assume the Chairperson's duties during temporary absence or incapacity.

If the office of Chairperson becomes permanently vacant, the Vice-Chairperson shall serve as Acting Chairperson until a replacement is elected. A replacement election must be held within sixty (60) calendar days.

Section 4.5 — Duties of the Secretary

The Secretary shall maintain membership records, meeting minutes, official correspondence, and the current version of these bylaws.

Draft minutes shall be distributed to the Executive Committee within ten (10) calendar days of each meeting. Approved minutes shall be made available to members within seven (7) calendar days after approval.

Section 4.6 — Duties of the Treasurer

The Treasurer shall maintain accurate financial records, monitor income and expenditure, collect membership fees, and prepare the annual financial report.

The Treasurer shall present a financial summary to the Executive Committee at least once every three (3) months.

The Treasurer may authorize routine expenditures of up to €250 per transaction within the approved budget. Expenditures above this amount require prior authorization under Article V.

Section 4.7 — Duties of the Events Coordinator

The Events Coordinator shall plan and coordinate Society activities, maintain the annual events calendar, and ensure that events comply with approved budgets and safety policies.

Events involving expected attendance exceeding fifty (50) persons require advance approval by the Executive Committee.

Section 4.8 — Executive Committee Meetings

The Executive Committee shall meet at least once every two (2) months.

Meetings may be convened by the Chairperson or by any two other officers acting jointly. At least five (5) calendar days' notice shall normally be provided.

Three (3) officers constitute a quorum. Decisions require a simple majority of votes cast by officers present. In the event of a tie, the motion is rejected.

Minutes shall be recorded for every meeting.

Section 4.9 — Removal and Vacancies

An officer may be removed by a two-thirds majority vote at a General Assembly, provided that removal was included in the meeting agenda and the officer received at least fourteen (14) calendar days' written notice.

An officer shall be given an opportunity to respond before the vote.

If an office other than Chairperson becomes vacant, the Executive Committee may appoint an Acting Officer by majority vote. The appointment expires at the next General Assembly, at which an election shall be held for the remainder of the term.

Article V — Financial Management

Section 5.1 — Financial Year

The financial year shall run from 1 January through 31 December.

The Treasurer shall prepare an annual financial report within sixty (60) calendar days after the end of each financial year.

Section 5.2 — Budget

The Executive Committee shall prepare a proposed annual budget and submit it to the Ordinary General Assembly for approval.

Expenditure shall normally remain within the approved budget. Transfers between budget categories exceeding €500 require Executive Committee approval and must be disclosed in the next financial report.

Section 5.3 — Expenditure Authorization

The following authorization limits apply:

- Up to €250 per transaction: Treasurer, provided the expense is budgeted.
- €250.01 to €1,000: approval by a majority of the Executive Committee.
- More than €1,000: approval by a two-thirds majority of the Executive Committee and subsequent disclosure to the next General Assembly.

Any unbudgeted expenditure exceeding €500 requires prior Executive Committee approval, regardless of the ordinary authorization limits.

No officer may approve a payment to themselves without the approval of the other eligible Executive Committee members.

Section 5.4 — Emergency Expenditure

Where immediate action is necessary to protect persons, property, or essential Society operations, the Chairperson and Treasurer may jointly authorize emergency expenditure of up to €1,500, even if the expenditure is not included in the approved budget.

The Executive Committee must be notified within forty-eight (48) hours. The expenditure must be documented and reviewed at the next Executive Committee meeting.

Emergency authorization may not be used to circumvent the ordinary approval process for planned purchases or events.

Section 5.5 — Financial Transparency

Members may request access to approved annual financial reports by submitting a written request to the Treasurer.

The Treasurer shall provide the report within fourteen (14) calendar days, subject to the protection of personal data and confidential third-party information.

Individual transaction records may be inspected by two members appointed by the General Assembly, provided that the inspection is conducted under reasonable confidentiality safeguards.

Section 5.6 — Reimbursement

Members and officers may request reimbursement for reasonable expenses incurred on behalf of the Society.

Requests must include receipts or equivalent documentation and be submitted within thirty (30) calendar days of the expenditure.

The Treasurer shall review complete requests within fourteen (14) calendar days. Reimbursement may be denied if the expense was unauthorized, insufficiently documented, or unrelated to Society activities.

A person may not approve their own reimbursement request.

Article VI — Committees and Activities

Section 6.1 — Establishment of Committees

The Executive Committee may establish standing or temporary committees to support the Society's work.

Each committee shall have a written mandate specifying its purpose, membership, authority, budget, and reporting obligations.

Committee members shall be appointed by the Executive Committee for terms not exceeding one (1) year. Appointments may be renewed.

Section 6.2 — Standing Committees

The Society shall maintain the following standing committees:

- **Events Committee:** Plans social gatherings, lectures, excursions, and cultural activities.
- **Membership Committee:** Supports recruitment, onboarding, and member engagement.
- **Audit Committee:** Reviews the Society's financial records and reports its findings to the General Assembly.

The Audit Committee shall consist of three (3) members who are not current Executive Committee officers. At least two members must be present for an audit decision or formal finding.

Section 6.3 — Committee Authority

Committees may make recommendations and implement approved activities within their mandates.

No committee may amend these bylaws, enter into a financial obligation exceeding its approved budget, or bind the Society to a contract exceeding €500 without prior Executive Committee approval.

Section 6.4 — Events and Conduct

All Society events shall comply with the code of conduct and applicable safety policies.

Alcohol may be served at approved events where lawful, provided that suitable non-alcoholic alternatives are available and participation does not require alcohol consumption.

The Executive Committee may cancel or postpone an event where there is a credible safety risk, insufficient funding, or a material breach of Society policy.

Article VII — Conflicts of Interest and Ethics

Section 7.1 — Disclosure

Any officer or committee member who has a personal, professional, or financial interest in a matter under consideration must disclose that interest before deliberation begins.

The disclosure shall be recorded in the meeting minutes.

Section 7.2 — Recusal

A person with a material conflict of interest shall not vote on the affected matter and shall not participate in deliberations unless the remaining decision-makers request factual information.

The remaining eligible participants shall determine whether the disclosed interest constitutes a material conflict.

Section 7.3 — Gifts and Benefits

Officers and committee members may not accept gifts or benefits worth more than €100 from a supplier or prospective supplier in connection with Society business.

Gifts of nominal value, such as promotional merchandise, may be accepted if they do not create an actual or apparent obligation.

Section 7.4 — Confidentiality

Members shall not disclose confidential membership information, private disciplinary proceedings, or non-public financial details to unauthorized persons.

This obligation does not prohibit disclosures required by applicable law or reports made in good faith concerning misconduct or safety concerns.

Article VIII — Amendments to the Bylaws

Section 8.1 — Proposed Amendments

An amendment may be proposed by the Executive Committee or by at least ten percent (10%) of eligible voting members.

Proposals must be submitted to the Secretary in writing at least twenty-one (21) calendar days before the General Assembly at which they will be considered.

The Secretary shall circulate the proposed wording to all members at least fourteen (14) calendar days before the meeting.

Section 8.2 — Approval Threshold

Amendments require a two-thirds majority of valid votes cast at a General Assembly where at least forty percent (40%) of all eligible voting members are present or participating electronically.

The reduced quorum under Section 3.5 shall not apply to constitutional amendments.

Section 8.3 — Effective Date

Unless otherwise specified in the adopted amendment, changes take effect immediately after the meeting at which they are approved.

The Secretary shall update the official document and distribute the revised version within fourteen (14) calendar days.

Article IX — Dissolution

Section 9.1 — Proposal

The Society may be dissolved only by a resolution passed at an Extraordinary General Assembly convened specifically for that purpose.

The dissolution proposal must be circulated to all members at least thirty (30) calendar days before the meeting.

Section 9.2 — Voting Requirements

Dissolution requires:

1. A quorum of at least fifty percent (50%) of all eligible voting members.
2. Approval by at least three-quarters (75%) of valid votes cast.

If the required quorum is not reached, a second Extraordinary General Assembly shall be convened within thirty (30) calendar days. The second meeting shall require a quorum of forty percent (40%) of eligible voting members, while the three-quarters voting threshold remains unchanged.

Section 9.3 — Distribution of Assets

Upon dissolution, all outstanding debts and obligations shall be settled first.

Remaining assets shall be transferred to one or more non-profit organizations with comparable educational, cultural, or community-oriented purposes, selected by the General Assembly.

No remaining assets may be distributed among members or officers.

Article X — Interpretation and Final Provisions

Section 10.1 — Interpretation

The Executive Committee shall interpret these bylaws in the first instance. A member may challenge an interpretation before the General Assembly, whose decision shall prevail within the Society.

No interpretation may override an explicit provision of these bylaws.

Section 10.2 — Precedence

Where a committee policy conflicts with these bylaws, these bylaws shall prevail.

Where an Executive Committee decision conflicts with a valid General Assembly resolution, the General Assembly resolution shall prevail.

Section 10.3 — Severability

If any provision of these bylaws is found invalid or unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall continue in effect to the extent possible.

The Society shall seek to replace the affected provision with a valid provision that most closely reflects its original purpose.

Section 10.4 — Official Language

The official language of the Society's records and governance shall be English. Informal events and internal communications may use other languages.

Section 10.5 — Adoption

These bylaws were adopted by resolution of the founding members of the Northstar Society on 15 March 2026 and entered into force on 1 April 2026.

Signed on behalf of the Society:

Chairperson: _____

Secretary: _____

Date: _____